NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

MIL-DTL-3943/87D
11 May 1999
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-3943/87C
1 May 1997

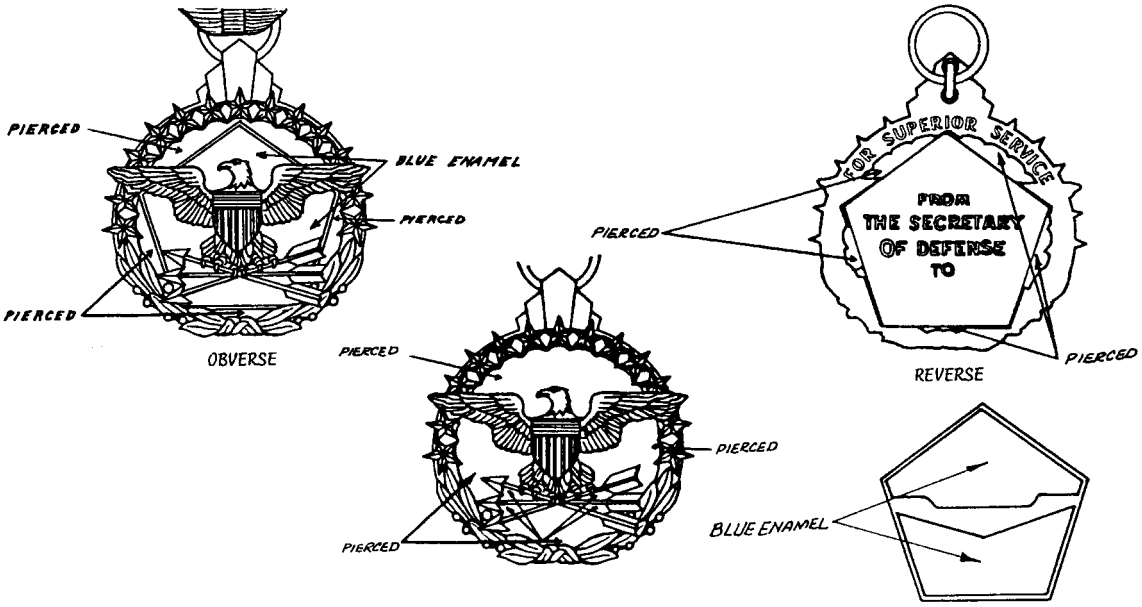
DETAIL SPECIFICATION SHEET

DECORATION, DEFENSE SUPERIOR SERVICE MEDAL

Inactive for new design after 14 January 1999.

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and the issue of MIL-DTL-3943 listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation.



DASH NO.
-1: Regular Size
-2: Miniature Size

MATERIAL:

SHELL (eagle and wreath): Red Brass
PENTAGON INSERT: Gilding Metal

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T23:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FINISH:

OBVERSE:
SHELL: Nickel Plated, Silver Plated, Oxidized, Relieved, Matte Finish and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 14.
INSERT: Hard Enameled, Nickel Plated, Silver Plated, Oxidized, Relieved, Matte Finish and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 14.

REVERSE: Nickel Plated, Silver Plated, Oxidized, Relieved, Matte Finish and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 14.

DIMENSIONS:

SHELL:
HEIGHT (overall):
-1: 1-7/8 inches (REF)
-2: 15/16 inch (REF)
WIDTH (overall):
-1: 1-5/8 inches (REF)
-2: 13/16 inch (REF)
THICKNESS (at shield):
-1: 0.135 inch ± 0.005 inch
-2: 0.090 inch ± 0.005 inch

INSERT:
HEIGHT (overall):
-1: 1-3/16 inches (REF)
-2: 19/32 inch (REF)
WIDTH (overall):
-1: 1-1/4 inches (REF)
-2: 5/8 inch (REF)
THICKNESS (at thickest point):
-1: 0.080 inch ± 0.005 inch
-2: 0.060 inch ± 0.005 inch

ASSEMBLED THICKNESS (at eagle's shield):
-1: 0.215 inch ± 0.010 inch
-2: 0.150 inch ± 0.010 inch

NOTES:

1. The term (REF) refers to the measurements taken from the Government furnished hub or die.

2. Enameled color shall be blue as indicated. The enamel color shall conform to the TIOH Hard Enamel Color Chip Number 33.

3. Epoxy resin (stoning epoxy) may be used in lieu of hard enamel at the option of the manufacturer. When epoxy resin is used in lieu of hard enamel, the material requirement shall be gilding metal or red brass.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T23:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. Pierced areas shall be as indicated.

5. The insert shall be soft soldered to the shell in the position shown.

6. The lug shall be located on the vertical center line of the shell and shall be fabricated from 0.065 inch ± 0.003 inch nominal diameter wire for Dash No. -1 and 0.040 inch ± 0.003 inch nominal diameter wire for Dash No. -2 with the same material and finish as the shell. The lug shall be a half circle hard soldered in the location shown with an outside diameter of 7/32 inch ± 1/64 inch for Dash No. -1 and 5/32 inch ± 1/64 inch for Dash No. -2.

7. Decoration set shall consist of a regular size medal, a service ribbon, and a lapel button all packaged in a presentation case conforming to MIL-DTL-14633, Type XIV, Style 8 with a Class 1 or 1A pad.

8. The ribbon for the pendant drape and service ribbon shall conform to MIL-DTL-11589/220.

9. The lapel button shall conform to MIL-DTL-11484/115.

CHANGES FROM PREVIOUS ISSUE: Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Air Force - 45
Navy - NU

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activities:
Air Force - 32, 82, 99
Navy - MC
Coast Guard - CG
DLA - CT

(Project No. 8455-0978)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T23:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.